

WORLDLINE 

Q3 Quick Peek 2025



Scan Tap Done - India pays in seconds

Payment to grow your world

Scan, Tap, Done — India Moves in Seconds.

Seamless retail. Digital-first payments. Data shaping every micro-moment.

Every scan tells a story — and every story becomes data. From a rickshaw ride to a late-night medicine purchase, Q3 2025 witnessed millions of new QR interactions capturing the pulse of India's evolving payment habits.



This quarter highlighted India's accelerating shift toward digital payments, backed by clear data signals:

34% YoY

UPI surged 34% YoY with expanding QR penetration across Bharat.

709M

709M active QRs made scan-and-pay the default for daily essentials.

29%

Online card payments rose 29%, led by strong credit and prepaid card usage.

12.12M

POS acceptance grew to 12.12M terminals, strengthening in-store digital rails.

P2M

Merchant-led UPI (P2M) grew faster than P2P, showing deeper retail adoption.

26% YoY

Credit card issuance grew 8% YoY to 113.39 million, reinforcing cards as a key rail for high-value and EMI-led spends.

This quick view distils those moments — UPI, cards, QR, merchants and banks — into one dynamic snapshot of Digital India in motion.

Table of Contents



1. Payments
Acceptance
Infrastructures

4. Card Issuance –
Credit, Debit &
Prepaid Cards

2. PoS Market
Share

5. Glossary

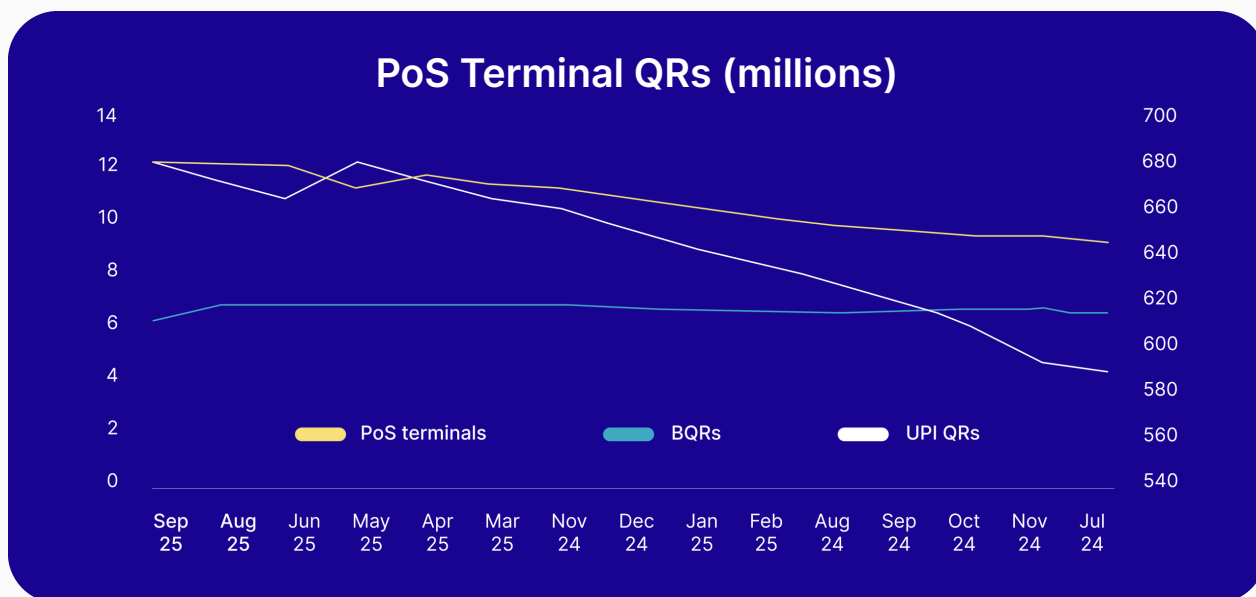
3. Unified Payment
Interface

6. Conclusion

Payments Acceptance Infrastructures

UPI Stays Strong, QR Adoption Deepens Across Bharat

Across the board, payments acceptance infrastructure channels have grown at a good clip. Between July 2024 and July 2025, PoS terminals grew by 35% to 12.12 million (from 9.34 million in July 2024), while BharatQR (BQR) decreased by 1% to 6.10 million (from 6.18 million in July 2024).



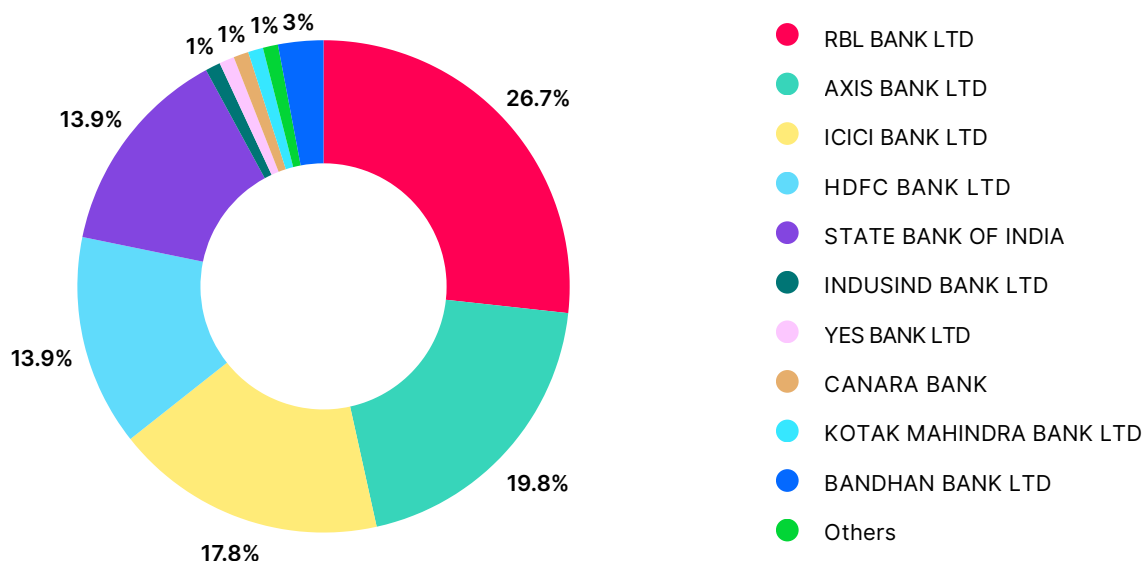
The standout, as expected, is UPI QRs, which grew by 21% to 709 million (from 588 million in July 2024), creating dense QR acceptance across kiranas and neighborhood merchants. From urban centers to rural outposts, these 709 million touchpoints have effectively made scan-and-pay the default mode for daily essentials across Bharat.



PoS Market Share

Top POS deployers:

PoS Market Share The deployment of physical terminals remains heavily consolidated. Top deployers, including RBL Bank, Axis Bank, ICICI Bank, and HDFC Bank, account for 97% of all terminals deployed as of September 2025.

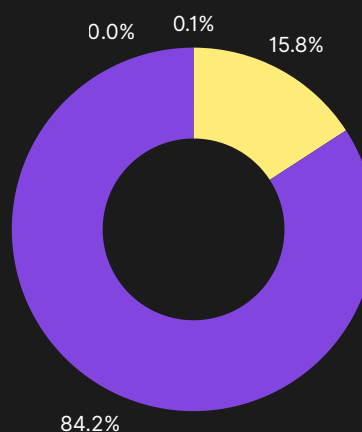


Private Sector Banks:
Dominate the
landscape with **84.2%**
market share.

**Public Sector
Banks: Account
for 15.8%.**

Foreign Banks:
Hold a negligible
0.1% share.

- Public Sector Banks
- Private Sector Banks
- Foreign Banks
- Payment Banks
- Small Finance Banks



Unified Payments Interface

UPI volumes continue to break records, reflecting a maturing digital economy. In Q3 2025, total UPI transaction volume hit 59.33 billion, a 33.5% increase from the 44.44 billion recorded in Q3 2024. Correspondingly, the value of these transactions climbed 21% to INR 74.84 trillion, up from INR 61.89 trillion in the same period last year.

UPI Transactions - Volume and Value



P2P and P2M Transactions

The narrative of Q3 2025 is defined by a structural shift: merchant-led P2M transactions are now rising faster than P2P, signaling UPI's definitive evolution into a retail-first platform.

P2M Volume: Grown by 35% to 37.46 billion transactions.

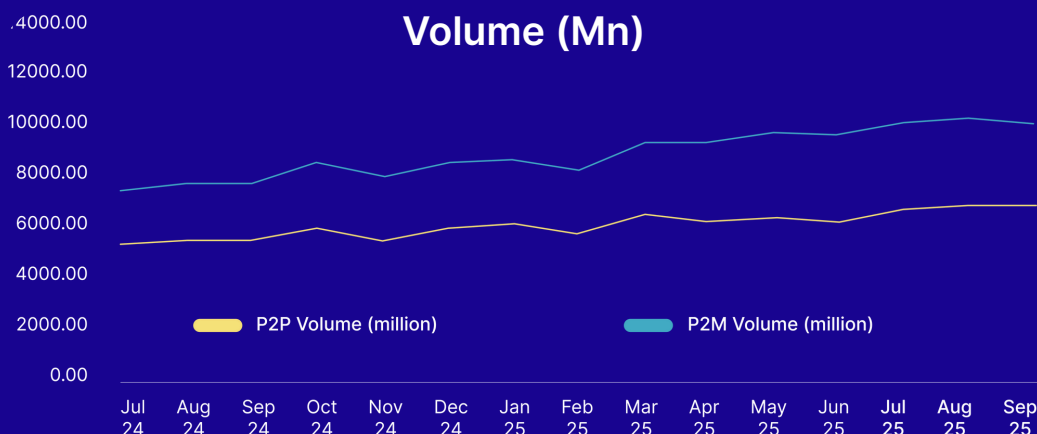


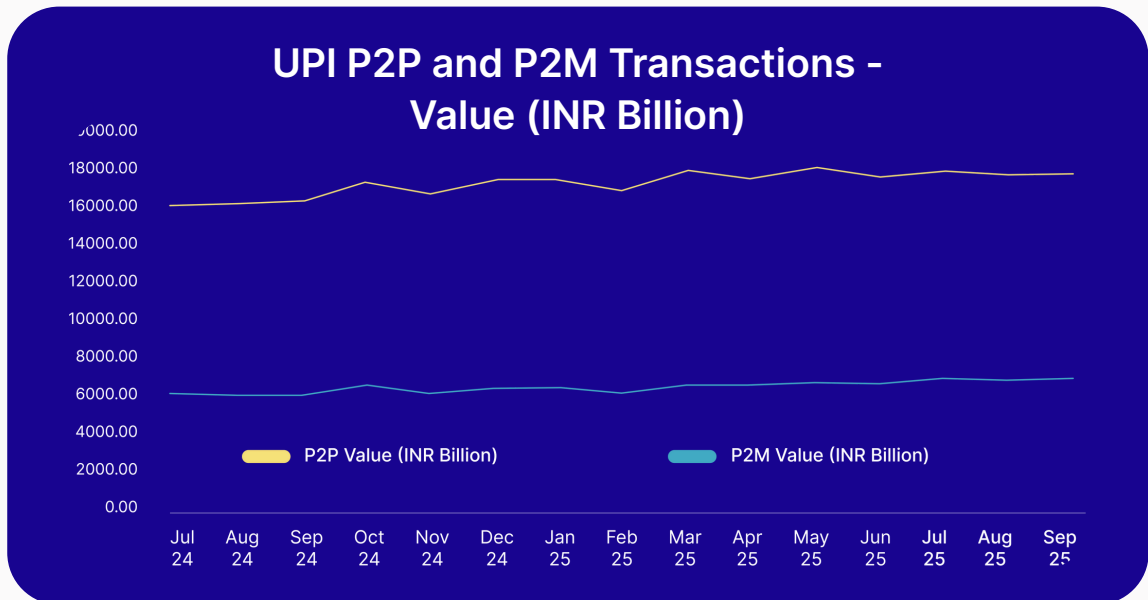
P2P Volume: Grown by 29% to 21.65 billion transactions.



While P2P remains vital for social payments, high-frequency categories such as transport, quick-service food, and healthcare have emerged as the primary engines driving P2M growth.

UPI P2P and P2M Transactions - Volume (Mn)

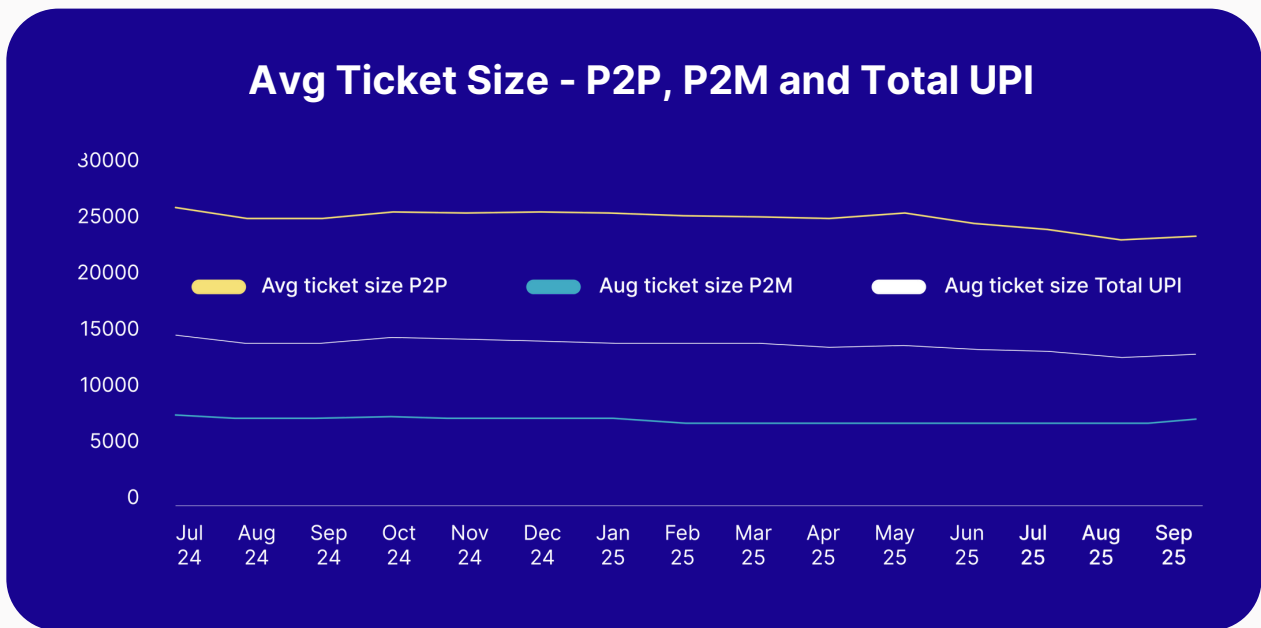




Average Ticket Size

As adoption broadens to include micro-transactions for tea, bus tickets, and vegetables, the Average Ticket Size (ATS) is shrinking for the right reasons. The overall ATS for UPI transactions in Q3 2025 stood at INR 1,262, a decrease from INR 1,363 in Q3 2024, reflecting a 9% drop driven by deeper usage in everyday, low-ticket categories.

A deeper look reveals distinct behaviours: P2P ATS decreased from INR 1,330 in Q3 2024 to INR 1,226 in Q3 2025, indicating smaller average personal transfers over time, while P2M ATS fell from INR 313 to INR 291, highlighting UPI’s penetration into low-value daily retail spends.



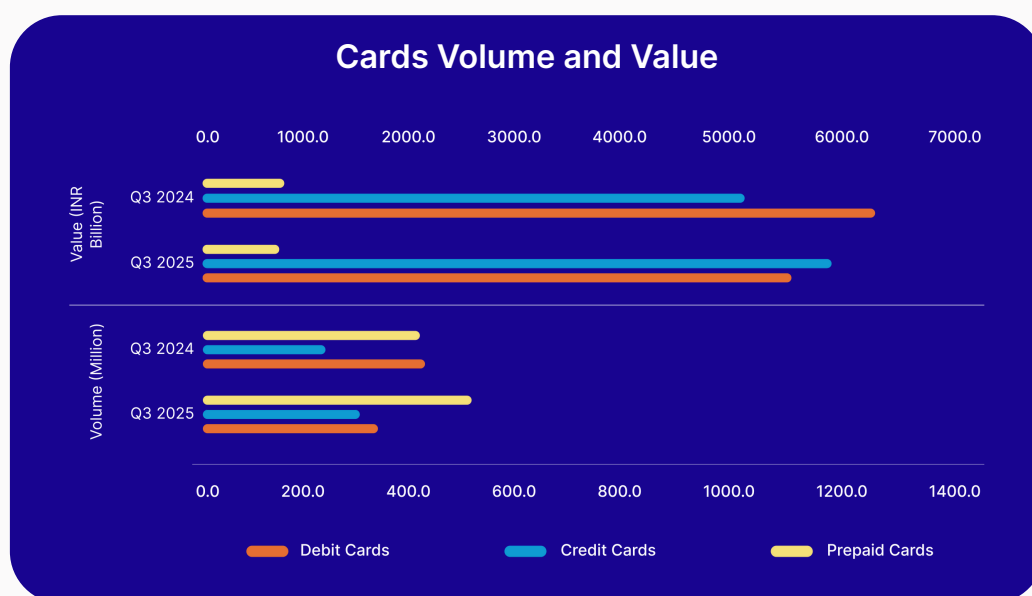
Card Issuance – Credit, Debit & Prepaid Cards

Q3 2025 card issuance was driven by credit cards, which grew 8% YoY to 113.39 million amid strong adoption of rewards and EMI features. Debit cards rose modestly to 1,024.82 million (+5% YoY) as UPI replaced them for routine payments, while prepaid cards expanded 24% YoY to 470.1 million, supported by corporate, transit and wallet-driven use cases.

Credit cards continued to dominate high-value spending, with transactions up 26% to 1.45 billion and value reaching INR 6.07 trillion. Debit card activity declined to 0.33 billion transactions (–22%) and INR 1.12 trillion (–13%) as users shifted to UPI and credit. Prepaid cards recorded strong gains 23% in volume and declined by 7% in value - reflecting their role in recurring, small-ticket transactions.

At POS, card usage remained resilient with 1.18 billion transactions (+5% YoY) worth INR 2.90 trillion. Credit cards grew to 735 million transactions (+23%) and INR 2.15 trillion. Debit card POS activity fell, while prepaid POS value increased slightly despite lower volumes. Tap-and-pay adoption continued rising.

Online card spending saw the fastest growth, reaching 1.13 billion transactions (+29%) and INR 4.38 trillion. Credit cards led overwhelmingly with 740 million transactions (+30%) worth INR 3.86 trillion. Debit card online use declined, while prepaid online volumes rose from a smaller base. ATS patterns remained consistent: POS ATS was INR 2,934 for credit, INR 2,908 for debit and INR 150 for prepaid, with online ATS higher across all card types.



	Volume (Million)		Value (INR Billion)	
	Q3 2025	Q3 2024	Q3 2025	Q3 2024
Credit cards	1475.0	1166.0	6017.3	5170.740
Debit Cards	328.9	423.3	1123.2	1284.100
Prepaid Cards	509.8	414.3	143.8	154.970

Glossary

Average Ticket Size (ATS)

The average value of a single transaction for a given payment instrument or channel (such as UPI, cards, POS or online), calculated by dividing total transaction value by total transaction volume.

Contactless / Tap-and-Pay

A payment mode where customers complete transactions by tapping a contactless-enabled card or device on a compatible terminal, without inserting or swiping the card.

Cross-Border QR Payments

QR-based payment transactions made by customers outside their home country, typically for travel, tourism or other spends, settled via interoperable QR arrangements across markets.

EMI (Equated Monthly Instalment)

A repayment structure that converts larger purchases or credit card dues into fixed monthly instalments over a defined tenure.

Interoperable QR

A QR code that can be scanned and paid using multiple apps or payment providers, enabling a single QR to accept payments from various customer applications.

Payment Acceptance Infrastructure

The combined network of physical and digital touchpoints where customers can pay digitally, including POS terminals, QR codes, payment gateways and related devices.

Point of Sale (PoS) Terminal

A physical device at a merchant outlet that accepts card payments via swipe, dip or tap, and processes transactions through card networks and banks.

Semi-Urban Tiers

Towns and smaller cities below major metros, often classified in lower-tier city categories, where digital payment acceptance is expanding beyond large urban centers.

Unified Payments Interface (UPI)

A real-time payment system that enables instant money transfers between bank accounts via mobile apps, using identifiers such as virtual payment addresses, mobile numbers or QR codes.

UPI P2P (Person-to-Person)

UPI transactions where funds move between individuals, typically for social, family or peer transfers.

UPI P2M (Person-to-Merchant)

UPI transactions where customers pay merchants for goods and services, such as at kirana stores, fuel stations, restaurants or online merchants.

Volume (of Transactions)

The total number of payment transactions processed via a particular channel or instrument over a defined period (for example, Q3 2025).

Value (of Transactions)

The total monetary amount processed via a particular payment channel or instrument over a defined period.

Conclusion

India's payment behavior has shifted from simple screen taps to a scan-first economy. Q3 2025 proved that digital payments are now a daily habit, not just a convenience.

The data shows a functioning balance: UPI drives high-frequency merchant transactions, while an 8% jump in credit card issuance secures high-value consumption.

The 709 million active QR codes have effectively connected the local kirana store to the formal economy, placing them on equal footing with modern retail. Overall, cards still complement UPI: credit cards lead high-value spends, prepaid cards grow in micro and recurring uses, while debit cards decline as digital payments advance.

These rails—scans for the daily, swipes for the aspirational—now run side-by-side. The global financial community is no longer the benchmark. India is setting the pace.



About Worldline India



Worldline is a leading Omnichannel payments technology player, building a robust payment ecosystem for over 26 years.

Worldline is the preferred partner for over 30 leading public and private sector banks, leading sectors like NBFCs, insurance companies, e-commerce businesses, startups, retail brands, hotel chains, and many more.

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